

THE DAILY BRIEF

SEPTEMBER 4, 2026

MARKETS & FINANCE

Stocks, crypto, and the macro signals moving money today

Wall Street ended sharply higher Thursday as Fed Governor Christopher Waller's dovish remarks pulled Treasury yields lower and reignited the AI megacap trade. All three major U.S. indexes gained more than 1%, with the Dow Jones Industrial Average climbing 624.16 points, or 1.18%, to close at 53,686.11; the S&P 500 adding 81.11 points, or 1.06%, to 7,747.71; and the Nasdaq Composite jumping 366.23 points, or 1.40%, to 26,584.06 — its best session since August 4. The rally was concentrated in the "Magnificent Seven" AI megacap group as a 10-year Treasury yield retreat eased rate-hike fears. The bond market's pivot matters because prediction markets had put the odds of a September Fed rate hike at roughly one in three and a cut near zero just a day earlier. (Reuters, CNBC)

U.S. spot bitcoin ETFs logged their largest single-day inflow since January, drawing \$731 million as Waller's comments rippled through risk assets. Bitcoin crossed back above \$80,000 in the same session, lifting total crypto market capitalization to \$2.82 trillion, with Zcash leading the rally alongside Strategy and other crypto-adjacent equities. Glassnode analysts cautioned that the recent bitcoin-gold correlation, which hit a six-year high this week, may not sustain a long-term decoupling from U.S. equities; similar decoupling episodes in past cycles proved short-lived. (The Block)

AMC shares jumped 21% overnight after CEO Adam Aron publicly slammed Robinhood's tokenized-share offering as "outrageous." The clash echoes OpenAI's earlier complaint that Robinhood had no authorization to issue tokenized exposures tied to its equity. AMC is the highest-profile public company to take a public stand, and the dispute highlights a growing fault line between traditional issuers and crypto rails that promise 24/7 settlement. Coinbase separately filed with the SEC to list 24/7 equity perpetual contracts, putting another pressure point on legacy market structure. (The Block)

New Jersey asked the U.S. Supreme Court to decide once and for all who regulates sports betting on prediction markets like Kalshi. A Michigan state court separately converted a June temporary restraining order into a preliminary injunction against Kalshi, with violations now triggering a \$500,000-per-day fine. The federal-state jurisdictional fight matters for every prediction-market venue — a SCOTUS ruling that event contracts are "swaps" under CFTC jurisdiction would let Kalshi-style platforms operate nationwide without state gambling licenses; a ruling the other way would force them into the patchwork of state-by-state sports betting regimes. (Ars Technica, The Block)

AI & TECH

The labs, models, and infrastructure deals setting the pace

Nvidia confirmed it will acquire Hugging Face for \$12.9 billion in its largest deal to date, betting that owning the largest open-model hub accelerates its grip on the AI stack. Of the headline figure, \$11.9 billion goes to shareholders and roughly \$1 billion in equity is reserved to retain Hugging Face employees who join Nvidia; the deal is expected to close

in the first half of next year. Hugging Face hosts more than 3 million models and is used by over 18 million developers, and Nvidia pledged the platform will stay open and model-agnostic, with Nvidia compute not required to build on or deploy through it. The acquisition signals Nvidia's move beyond chips into the software and community layer of generative AI, complementing its 500+ open models and 250+ open datasets already on the platform. (TechCrunch, Nvidia Blog)

OpenAI launched Astra, calling it a "new frontier" on computer and browser use and its most powerful model yet.

The release went first to enterprise customers on OpenAI's Daybreak cybersecurity program, with broader availability promised "soon." OpenAI positions Astra as state-of-the-art on computer use, browser use, software engineering, cybersecurity, science, and professional work, and as the first model to meet its "Critical" cybersecurity capability threshold. The launch comes on the heels of an overlapping multi-hour outage Thursday morning that hit ChatGPT, Claude, Grok, and Gemini simultaneously — a rare synchronized degradation that underscored how concentrated the AI supply chain has become. (TechCrunch, Ars Technica)

Crusoe, the AI-aligned data-center developer, raised \$3 billion at a \$30 billion valuation, with sources saying the round came together after the company secured a \$13 billion contract with Jane Street. The deal positions Crusoe as one of the most heavily capitalized neoclouds in the Western market, reflecting the capital intensity of building capacity for frontier-model training and inference. (TechCrunch)

Mira Murati's Thinking Machines Lab is in talks with Accel to lead a \$1 billion round at a \$40 billion valuation, with the company's annual revenue run rate already above \$100 million. The valuation step-up comes just months after the startup's emergence from stealth and reflects continued investor appetite for talent-led frontier-model labs outside the incumbents. (TechCrunch)

The federal government opened an investigation into Tesla's Cybercab deployment just hours after the first production units hit the road in Austin. Tesla separately published a form on its website soliciting interest from operators who want to buy and run Cybercab fleets, signaling an asset-light, franchised-fleet model for the driverless two-seater. The launch carries existential weight: Cybercab has no steering wheel or pedals and represents Tesla's clearest "fork in the road" between consumer automaker and autonomous service operator. (TechCrunch)

BRIEFLY

< **Crypto bank pipeline:** Andreessen Horowitz-backed OpenReserve and Revolut both received preliminary OCC approval for national bank charters this week, accelerating the buildout of onchain-native U.S. banking infrastructure. (The Block)

< **El Salvador bitcoin pause:** The IMF confirmed El Salvador has not used public funds to accumulate bitcoin since June 2025; recent purchases came from private donations. (The Block)

< **Oura files to go public:** The smart-ring maker submitted its IPO paperwork, citing significant revenue growth over the past year, just as Circular launched the Ring 3 with contactless payments and Ultrahuman raised \$70M from Qualcomm to chase a \$200M ARR run rate by January 2027. (TechCrunch)

THE TAKEAWAY

Two stories anchor today's tape. Nvidia's \$12.9 billion bet on Hugging Face reframes the chip vendor as a software-and-community platform, and the simultaneous launch of OpenAI's Astra at the "Critical" cybersecurity tier shows where the frontier is moving next. On the macro side, Waller's pivot pulled yields lower, reignited the AI megacap trade, and pulled \$731 million into spot bitcoin ETFs in a single session — the largest inflow since January. The underlying signal in both is the same: liquidity is searching for the next durable narrative, and right now everything from open models to prediction markets is being repriced as part of the same AI infrastructure story.

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